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CENTER FOR ACADEMIC AND PROFESSIONAL ADVANCEMENT
THE AMERICAN UNIVERSITY OF KURDISTAN

Youth Entrepreneurship Program

One product, ten prices.

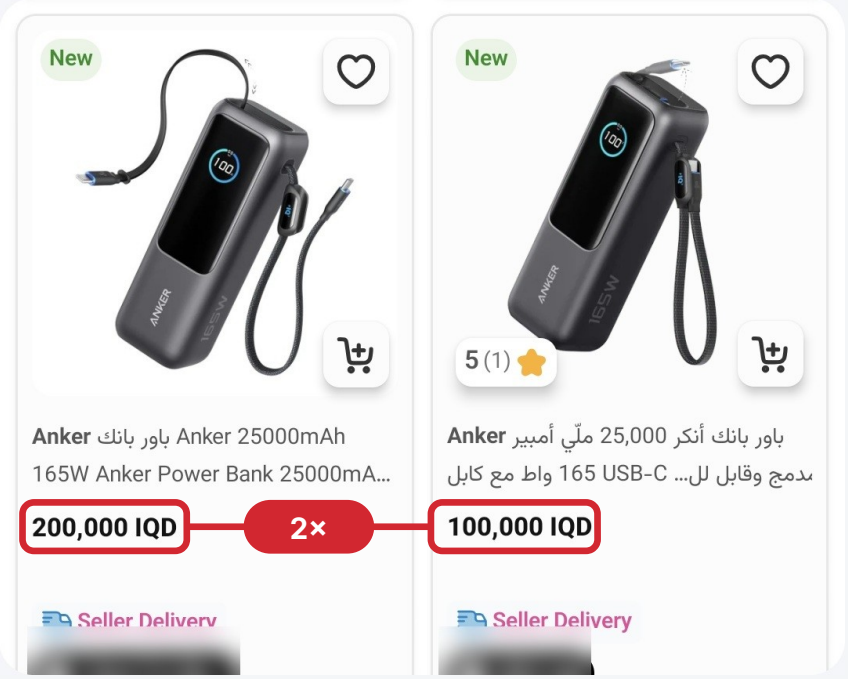
Shakir Bashar · Founder

4 November 2026

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Problem

Online in Iraq, you can't know the real price before you buy.



Same search. Same screen. Same model.

Anker 25,000 mAh · 165 W

Miswag search grid

Seller 1	100,000 IQD
Seller 2	200,000 IQD

2× the price

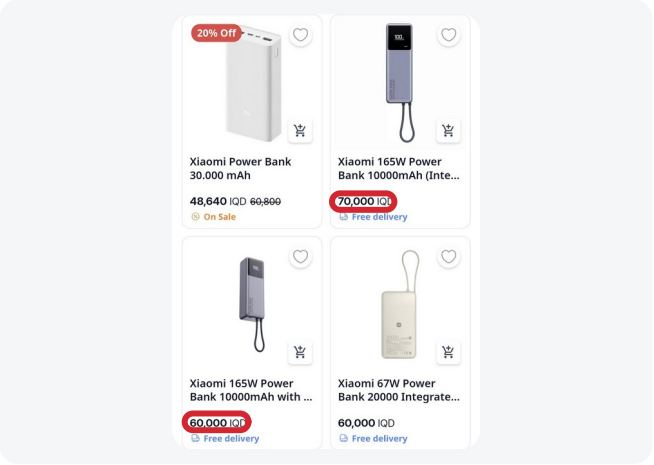
same power bank

+100,000 IQD on the same screen

Miswag app, 20 Oct 2026. Seller names blurred.

Problem · evidence

And it's the whole market.



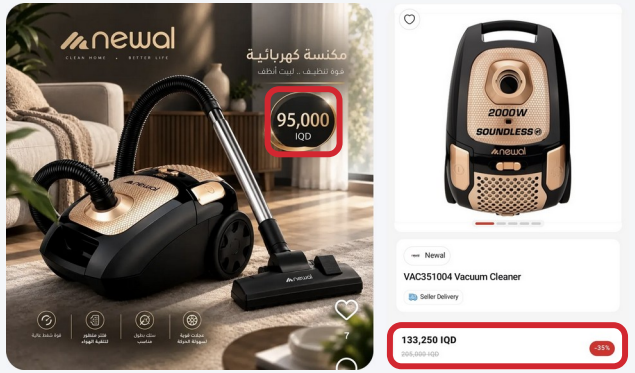
Same item, listed twice

60,000 vs 70,000 IQD



No price — just 'DM us'

Buyer asks: “How much?”



A fake 35% discount

95,000 IG vs 133,250 “deal”

97% **of 179 shoppers we surveyed see this.**

Screenshots Sep–Oct 2026 (seller names blurred) · Cheapify market survey, n=199 (179 shoppers, 20 merchants), Sep–Oct 2026.

Solution

Cheapify puts every seller's real price for the same product on one page.



Anker Power Bank 25,000 mAh · 165 W

One page · every verified seller

Seller	Item	Delivery	Doorstep total	Arrives	
Store A · Duhok	92,000	+3,000	**95,000 IQD**	Today	BEST VALUE
Store D · Erbil	91,000	+5,000	**96,000 IQD**	1–2 days	
Store B · Duhok	99,000	+3,000	**102,000 IQD**	Today	
Store C · Duhok	121,000	+3,000	**124,000 IQD**	Today	

Best Value rules

1. **Lowest doorstep total**
2. **Fastest delivery**
3. **Best seller rating**

Ranking can't be bought.

Illustration — store names and prices are examples.

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Value proposition

Shoppers save. Merchants sell.

For shoppers

Every price, side by side
No more checking ten pages

Order in 30 seconds
No “price?” DMs, no waiting

Cash on delivery or card
Doorstep total shown upfront

For merchants

Orders, not interrogations
Ready orders with address and variant

Free dashboard
Stock, orders and payouts in one place

Fair, low fee
About 3.8% on a typical 25,000 IQD order

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Target market

Duhok first: about 1 million people.



39.6M online · $1.32B a year

≈ 1.34M online · ≈ $46M a year

Duhok · Semel · Zakho

≈ 0.89M
online

≈ $30M
a year online

~390
regular shoppers to break even

≈ 585 orders a month
0.4% of launch-area online shopping

Population: 2024 national census (Ministry of Planning). Internet: DataReportal 2026. E-commerce: ECDB 2025. Duhok online figures (≈) = Iraq rate × population share.

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Target customers

Budget-conscious shoppers who already compare prices.

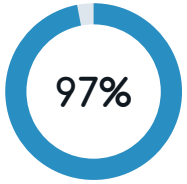
Shoppers

targeting plan

Time-poor professionals
Chargers, perfume, gadgets — 23–38

Household budget buyers
Kitchen, home, personal care — 26–48

Students & deal hunters
Cables, earbuds, gaming — 18–24



notice big price gaps on the same item
179 surveyed shoppers

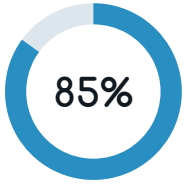
Merchants

Duhok social shops

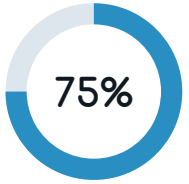
Social-commerce sellers
Sell via DMs with digital photos ready — IG · FB · TikTok

1,500 – 50,000 followers
Active local audience per page — 20–150 products

20 founding stores at launch
Signed in person · 0% fee in month 1 — ~8 leads ready



sell on IG / FB
20 surveyed shops



want to try
Cheapify at launch

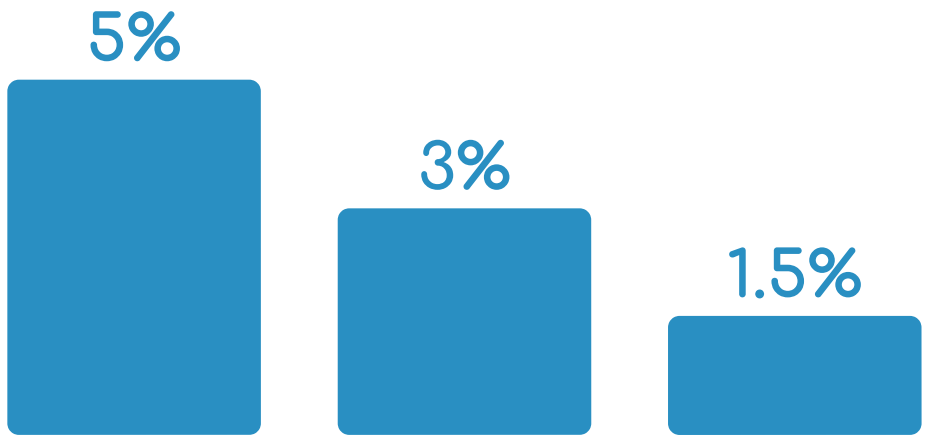
Age groups are our targeting plan — the survey did not ask age. Survey n=199 (179 shoppers, 20 merchants), Sep–Oct 2026.

Business model

We earn only when an order is delivered.

Our fee

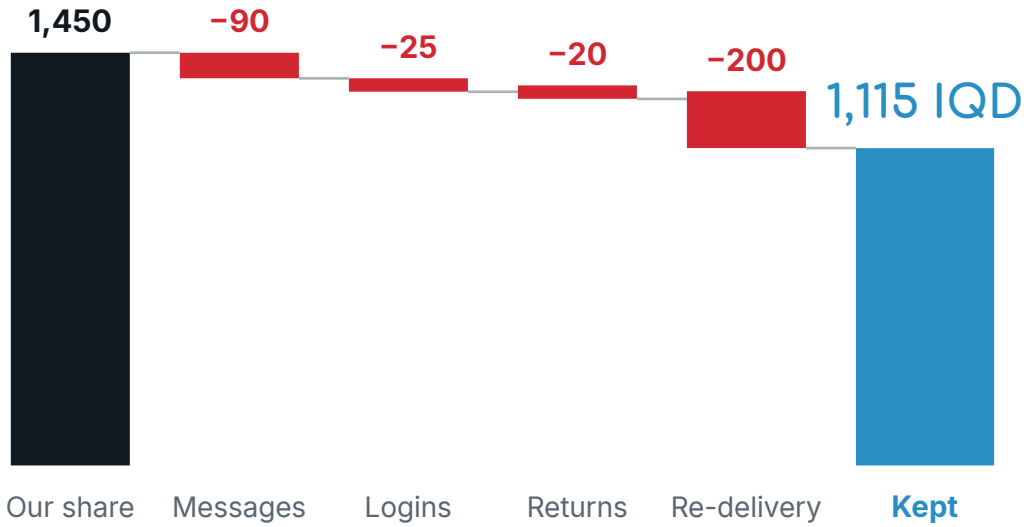
Lighter as prices rise



Typical 25,000 IQD order → 950 IQD fee + 500 delivery margin.

Per order

From our 1,450 IQD share to net profit



Example: 25,000 IQD item, cash on delivery, Duhok city; courier rate 2,500 IQD quoted by Fast Delivery (Duhok). Delivery margin applies once the courier contract is signed.

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Competitor analysis

Nobody else puts every seller on one page.

	Instagram / Facebook	Miswag	iBazzar	Elryan	Cheapify
Prices shown upfront	◐	✓	✓	✓	✓
One page per product	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Every seller compared on that page	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓
Third-party sellers can join	✓	✓	✓	✗	✓

✓ yes ◐ partly ✗ no

Based on in-app screenshots (Sep–Oct 2026) and public platform information.

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Growth strategy

We grow on two sides: stores and shoppers.

Stores

- Signed in person · 20 stores
- 0% in month 1
- Free ads
- Their followers · 1.5k–50k each



Shoppers

- Targeted ads · $2,200
- Short videos
- Campus deals · 3 universities
- Referrals · 52 on the waitlist

Duhok · Semel · Zakho → Erbil · Mosul · Sulaymaniyah → All of Iraq

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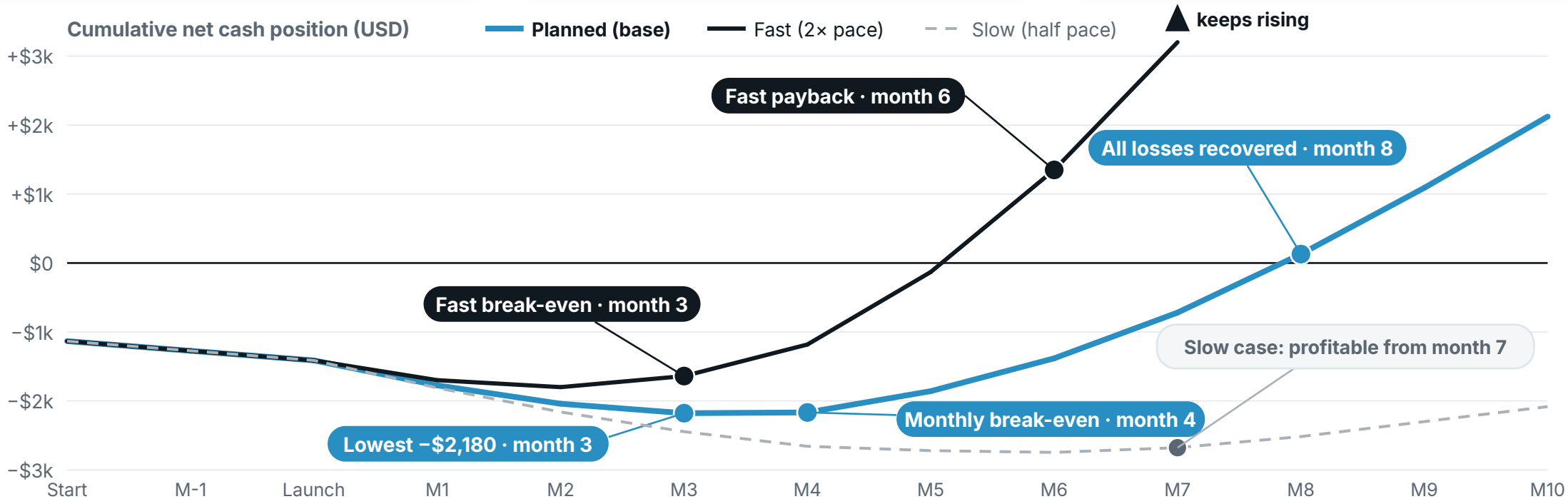
Financial feasibility

Profitable from month 4. Everything earned back by month 8.

Costs $435 / month
from month 6: $527

Break-even 585 orders / mo
≈ 390 regular shoppers

Payback month 8
fast case: month 6



Planned: orders grow 100 → 2,000/month; Fast: 2× pace; Slow: half pace. Costs $435/month (652,000 IQD; $527 from month 6), incl. 1.7M IQD startup. USD at 1,500 IQD.

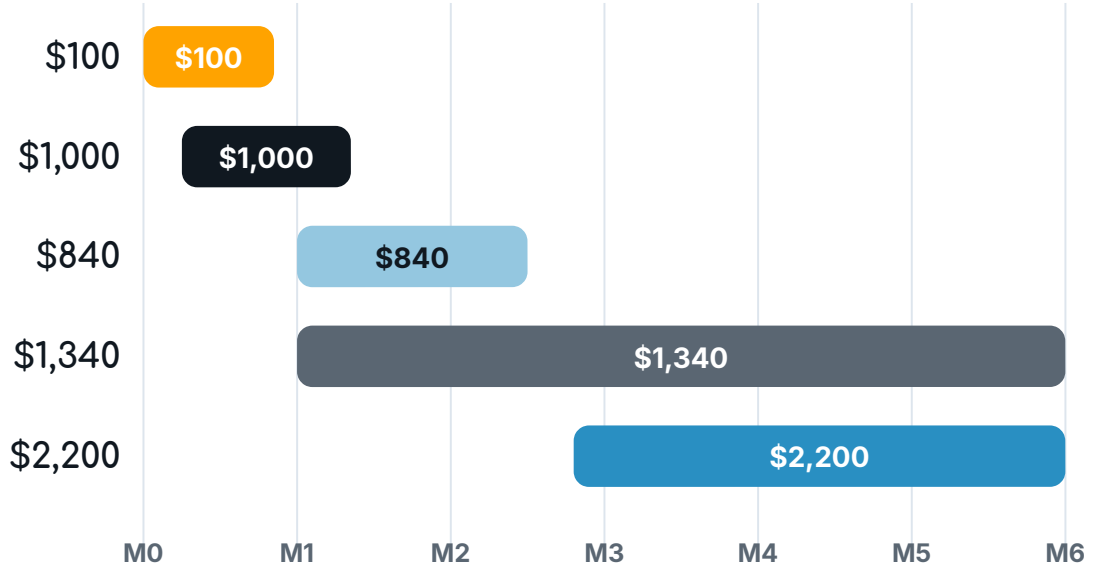
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Funding

What $5,480 makes possible.

$5,480 total ask

When each dollar is spent (M0 → M6)



Less? Still a plan.

$3,280
Launches + slow-case runway
Pilot + registration + 20 stores + full $1,340 slow-case runway

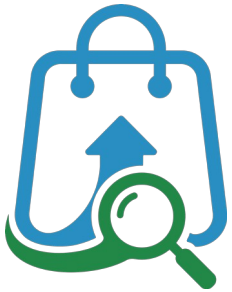
$2,710
Minimum self-funding launch
Pilot + registration + 20 stores + $770 planned-case runway

No salaries. No developers. I build the platform myself.

Registration: official KRI fee schedule · USD at the CBI rate of 1,500 IQD.

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Thank you

The bright side of choosing.

getcheapify.com

Shakir Bashar · Founder

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Appendix

Progressive fee schedule: lighter as prices rise

5% on the first 10,000 IQD · 3% on 10,001–100,000 · 1.5% above 100,000 — marginal brackets so a higher price never pays a higher rate.

Item price (IQD)	Cheapify fee (IQD)	Merchant keeps (IQD)	Effective fee rate
5,000	250	4,750	5.0%
10,000	500	9,500	5.0%
25,000 (typical order)	**950**	**24,050**	**3.8%**
45,000	1,550	43,450	3.4%
100,000	3,200	96,800	3.2%
150,000	3,950	146,050	2.6%
350,000	6,950	343,050	2.0%
1,200,000	19,700	1,180,300	1.6%

On a typical 25,000 IQD order, the merchant keeps 96.2% (24,050 IQD) and Cheapify earns 950 IQD.

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Appendix

Unit economics, payment methods & sensitivity

Per 25,000 IQD order (Duhok city, COD)	IQD
Platform fee (5% first 10k + 3% next 15k)	+950
Delivery margin (3,000 charged − 2,500 courier contract)	+500
WhatsApp alerts (−90) & OTP login codes (−25)	−115
Returns (−20) & failed-delivery re-attempts (−200)	−220
Kept per delivered order (COD base case)	**+1,115**

Payment method / sensitivity case	Gateway fee	Kept / order	Break-even
Cash on delivery (base case)	**0 IQD**	**1,115 IQD**	**~585 / mo**
SuperQi wallet (Qi 2026 promo; no door failure)	0 IQD (0%)	1,315 IQD	~496 / mo
FIB in-app QR (0.3% on 28k; no door failure)	~84 IQD	1,231 IQD	~530 / mo
Visa / Mastercard (≤1% CBI cap; no door failure)	≤280 IQD	1,035 IQD	~630 / mo
No courier contract signed (COD)	0 IQD	615 IQD	~1,060 / mo

Pre-paid orders remove the 200 IQD failed-delivery cost, so SuperQi and FIB QR earn even more per order than COD.

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Appendix

Three growth scenarios & low-point composition

Scenario	Orders at M6	Lowest cash point	Monthly break-even	All losses recovered
Fast (2× planned pace)	2,700 / month	−$1,800 (M2)	Month 3	Month 6
Planned (base case)	**1,350 / month**	**−$2,180 (M3)**	**Month 4**	**Month 8**
Slow (half the planned pace)	675 / month	−$2,750 (M6)	Month 7	~Month 20

Component of the −$2,180 (−3.27M IQD) planned low point	IQD	USD	Funded by
Startup costs (registration, 20 store kits, labels, app stores)	1,700,000	$1,133	Grant (lines 2 & 3)
Two development months before launch (M-2, M-1)	420,000	$280	Founder (pre-award)
Operating losses M1–M3 (planned pace; slow case is $1,340)	1,147,625	$765	Grant (line 5 runway)
Total planned cash low point (Month 3)	**3,267,625**	**$2,178**	**Each cost funded once**

Even at half the planned order pace (Slow case), losses stay capped by our $435/mo burn and turn profitable in Month 7.

Appendix

Market validation survey: 199 responses (Sep–Oct 2026)

Shoppers (n = 179)

97%	notice price gaps on the exact same item (39% always see large gaps)
88%	would use a side-by-side comparison app (only 2% prefer DMs)
Top pains	untrusted/duplicate pages 52% · found cheaper after buying 47% · DM price interrogation 46%
~52 leads	actionable beta-waitlist contacts (38 phone numbers + 14 Instagram handles)

Merchants (n = 20)

85%	sell primarily on Instagram and Facebook
75%	want to try Cheapify (15% maybe depending on commission · 10% no)
Top pains	'price?' DMs 55% · random price undercutting 45% · own-app cost 35% · courier coordination 35%
~8 leads	validated pilot-store leads ready for in-person onboarding (target: 20 founding stores)

Limitations noted honestly: self-selected sample (168 AR / 21 EN / 10 KU) — the $100 hand-run pilot tests real buying.

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Appendix

Six documented price-variation cases in our market

Product	Lowest price	Highest price	Spread	Where captured
Anker 25K 165W power bank (flagship)	**90,000 IQD (IG)**	**200,000 IQD (Miswag)**	**+122%**	**Instagram, iBazzar, Miswag**
Hoco HX80 portable espresso maker	25,000 IQD (IG)	35,280 IQD (Miswag)	+41%	Instagram vs Miswag
Newal VAC-3510 2000W vacuum	95,000 IQD (IG)	133,250 IQD (Miswag)	+40%	Instagram vs Miswag ('−35%')
ASUS VA24EHF 24" monitor	135,000 IQD (Elryan)	163,350 IQD (Miswag)	+21%	Elryan vs Miswag
Xiaomi 165W 10,000 mAh power bank	60,000 IQD	70,000 IQD	+17%	Inside the same app (iBazzar)
Espresso machines (2 seller posts)	Hidden	Hidden	No price	Instagram ('call / DM to order')

Price gaps of 17% to 122% appear across both social sellers and major apps — even inside the same app's search screen.

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Appendix

Top operational risks and how we handle them

Risk	Mitigation built into the model
Slower shopper adoption than planned	**Model sized to conservative ramp; slow case (half pace) is covered by the $1,340 runway; $100 pilot validates demand first**
Buyers and sellers bypass the app	Low ~3.8% fee, no seller phone numbers on waybills, ratings and referral credits work only on-platform
Courier contract or registration delayed	Registration is funded in M0 right after the pilot; second courier quote in hand; even without the 500 margin, orders stay +615 IQD positive
Failed COD deliveries ('not at home')	200 IQD/order budgeted for re-delivery; one free re-attempt; 3 failures disable COD for that buyer; WhatsApp pre-dispatch check
Late COD cash transfer from courier	Contract sets a 24h transfer target; merchant payouts release only after 48h return window AND courier transfer

Every top risk is addressed before scale: low burn ($435/mo), $100 validation gate, and strict COD custody rules.

Appendix

End-to-end order, payment & return flow

1. Checkout

Cash on delivery or card; doorstep total upfront

2. Store accepts

Dashboard + WhatsApp alert; 2h SLA

3. Sealed pack

Opaque mailer + waybill; security tape ≥50k

4. Courier pickup

Fast Delivery (Duhok) picks up same day

5. Doorstep delivery

Courier collects COD cash & transfers electronically

6. Auto payout

Merchant paid 48h after delivery, minus fee

48-hour return window

Faulty / wrong item: merchant pays return shipping. Buyer remorse (unopened): buyer pays 3,000 IQD return fee.

Zero cash handled by Cheapify

Courier transfers COD funds electronically to Cheapify; card/wallet orders settle via FIB / SuperQi / Switch gateway.

Cheapify never touches physical cash, and paying merchants after the 48-hour return window avoids clawbacks.

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How we sized the Duhok launch market

Metric	Value	Calculation	Source
Launch-area population	1,062,224	Duhok 497,029 + Zakho 398,876 + Semel 166,319	2024 national census
Duhok governorate population	1,599,871	All 7 districts of Duhok governorate	2024 national census
Launch-area internet users (est.)	≈ 0.89M	1,062,224 × 83.8% Iraq internet penetration	DataReportal 2026 rate
Launch-area online shopping (est.)	≈ $30M / year	2.30% share of Iraq population × $1,317M Iraq e-commerce	ECDB Iraq 2025
Break-even order volume	~585 orders / mo	652,000 IQD monthly burn ÷ 1,115 IQD kept per order (~$117k/yr GMV)	Cheapify financial model
Regular shoppers at break-even	**~390 shoppers**	**585 orders/month ÷ 1.5 orders/month per active shopper (≈ 0.4% of market)**	**Cheapify financial model**

Break-even requires only ~390 regular shoppers (~585 orders/month) out of ~890,000 internet users in Duhok, Semel and Zakho.

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Appendix

Funding detail: 6 computed lines & monthly release

#	Grant component	USD	IQD	When	Derivation
1	Hand-run concierge pilot	$100	150,000	M0	15–20 real orders on MVP before registration (~5–7k IQD/order)
2	Company registration & filing	$1,000	1,500,000	M0	154.5k Companies Reg. + 1,140k Chamber (English) + ~200k filing
3	Launch setup (20 stores + apps)	$710	1,061,000	M1	20 kits × 40k (800k) + labels (75k) + Apple ($99) + Google ($25)
4	Founding-store 0% month-1 offer	$130	190,000	M1–M2	0% fee in M1: ~200 orders × 950 IQD typical fee waived
5	Operating runway (slow-case cap)	$1,340	1,998,400	M1–M6	Slow-case monthly loss cap: 596k + 524k + 429k + 318k + 95k + 37k
6	Growth marketing push	$2,200	3,300,000	M3–M6	4 months × 825k IQD ($550/mo) ads + campus (~900 shoppers)
	Total grant request	**$5,480**	**8,199,400**	**M0–M6**	**Exact IQD = $5,466 at 1,500 CBI rate; each line rounded up to $10**

M0	M1	M2	M3	M4	M5	M6
$1,100	$1,180	$414	$836	$762	$613	$575
Pilot + registration	Setup + offer + runway	Offer + runway	Runway + ads start	Break-even + ads	Runway + ads	Self-funding

Runway is released only against actual monthly losses — the planned case uses ~$765 of the $1,340 cap.